Lab 1: Prepare HR Cases and Draft the HR Service Brief

Topic 1 · 30 minutes · v9.5 · 21 October 2026

You are Lumina Living's HR operations executive. A Q3 export contains repeated IDs and inconsistent category labels. You will clean a copy in Excel, reconcile its controls, and use the verified result to draft a Word HR service brief. The same department, status and assignment definitions underpin every later report.

Learning outcome: LO1: predict and mitigate integration challenges through verified cross-app grounding and handoffs.

Expected outcome: Lumina_Clean_HR_Cases.xlsx and Lumina_HR_Service_Brief.docx, with reconciled counts, reporting scope and a source register.

Files

- Instruction PDF
- Copy-ready prompts
- `data/Lumina_HR_Cases.xlsx` — synthetic Lumina source
- `data/templates/` — learner starting templates
- `data/checkpoints/` — clearly labelled rejoin evidence

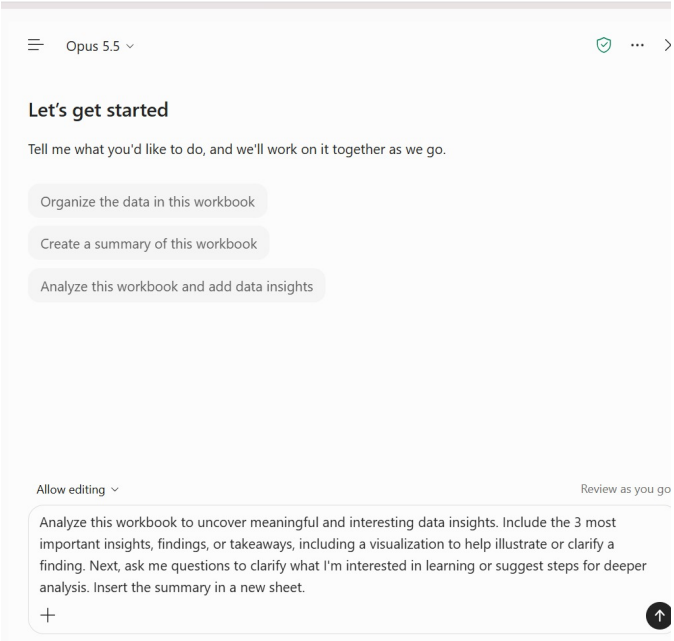
Prerequisites

- Microsoft 365 account with Copilot available in Word, Excel, PowerPoint and Outlook. Availability depends on the assigned licence and tenant settings; confirm access with the trainer before class.
- Desktop Excel on Windows or Mac is recommended; save working copies to your assigned OneDrive course folder with AutoSave on. Do not overwrite the supplied input.
- Download this whole lab folder. All files are synthetic; Lumina-HR-v9 is your own learner output folder.

Screen Guide

The Copilot screens you will use in this lab. The same screenshots and explanations are in the slides and Learner Guide.

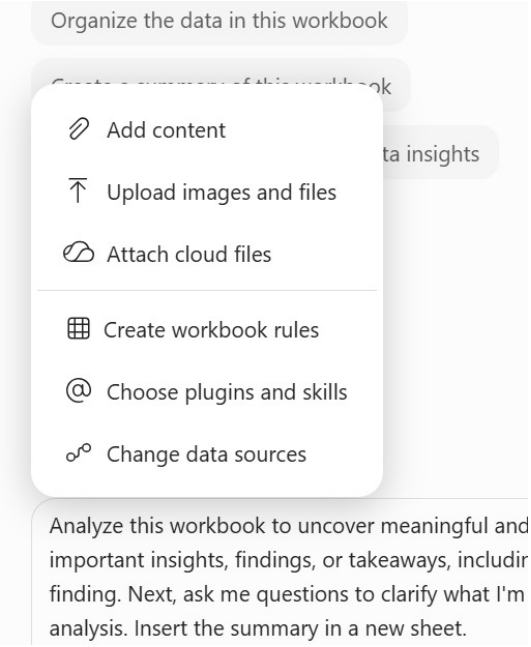
Copilot in Excel — The Chat Pane



- **Open the pane:** Select Copilot on the Home ribbon or the Copilot button at the bottom-right of the grid.

- **Model picker:** Shows the model in use. Auto picks one per task; keep the approved default.
- **Starter prompts:** Replace generic starters with a grounded request: goal, source, 30 Sep 2026 and scope.
- **Mode and review:** Allow editing changes the workbook; Review as you go lets you keep or undo each change.
- **Prompt box and +:** Paste the lab prompt; use + to attach the exact Lumina source before sending.

Ground the Request with the + Menu



- **Attach cloud files:** Point Copilot at the approved OneDrive copy of Lumina_HR_Cases.xlsx.
- **Upload images and files:** Add a local file, such as a supplied HR template, when the lab asks for it.
- **Create workbook rules:** Starts a visible .Rules sheet of workbook conventions (Lab 4).
- **Choose plugins and skills:** Invoke a built-in or custom Skill such as hr-case-pareto (Labs 5–7).
- **Change data sources:** Confirm which data Copilot reads before you trust any figure.

Steps

Step 1. Copy data/Lumina_HR_Cases.xlsx to your OneDrive Lumina-HR-v9 folder as Lumina_Clean_HR_Cases.xlsx. Open it in Excel, set Formulas > Calculation Options > Automatic, and read About_This_Data and Control. The workbook is the deliberately dirty 122-row input; the supplied CSV is a clean reference and must not replace the cleaning exercise. Open Copilot from Home > Copilot.

PROMPT — copy and adapt

```
EXCEL - CHAT ONLY:
Read About_This_Data and Control for Lumina Living. Explain what one employee HR case
represents, the reporting date, the five request types and how current owners differ from
proposed owners. Do not edit or infer employee impacts.
```

Step 2. Use Chat only to inspect the named table before making changes. Record row count and the two exact repeated IDs. A Case_ID is the row grain; do not count repeated export records twice.

PROMPT — copy and adapt

```
EXCEL - CHAT ONLY:
Inspect tblHRCases. Report row count, duplicate Case_ID values, category spelling variants and
missing Assigned_To. Do not edit. Treat 2026-09-30 as the fixed reporting date.
```

Step 3. Choose Plan if available. Read the proposed cleaning plan before using Allow editing. The duplicates are exact repeated export records: keep one per ID. Trim and standardise category labels to Leave Request, Training Request, Onboarding, Payroll Query, Benefits Claim; preserve missing owners and all unique source values. Save a copy of the raw sheet before the change.

PROMPT — copy and adapt

```
EXCEL - PLAN:
Plan to retain an untouched Raw_Export copy, remove only exact duplicate records by Case_ID,
and standardise category spelling in tblHRCases. Keep dates, statuses and assignments. Ask if
two records with one ID differ.

EXCEL - ALLOW EDITING:
Apply the reviewed plan. Keep one identical record per repeated ID. Do not guess missing
owners. Reconcile the cleaned table against Control.
```

Step 4. Add a Checks sheet or use the supplied one. Ask for formulas, then inspect the table and formulas yourself. Overdue excludes Closed and Cancelled and uses strictly earlier than the fixed date, so a due-today case is not overdue. Copy verified values to data/templates/Evidence_Register.csv.

PROMPT — copy and adapt

```
EXCEL - ALLOW EDITING:
In Checks calculate total rows, closed, cancelled, backlog, overdue backlog, unassigned
backlog and total Cost_SGD for tblHRCases. Use Control!B2 as reporting date. Define backlog as
Status neither Closed nor Cancelled. Add the identity total = closed + cancelled + backlog. Do
not change source data.
```

Step 5. Open data/templates/Lumina_HR_Service_Brief_Template.docx in Word and save as Lumina_HR_Service_Brief.docx in OneDrive. In Copilot select the verified source file using Reference a file or /. If Word cannot use the workbook, copy your verified evidence table plus data/Lumina_HR_Context.txt into the document and select that text; do not imply Word reads the Excel chat.

PROMPT — copy and adapt

```
WORD COPILOT:
Draft a one-page Lumina HR service brief from the verified evidence supplied here. Include
reporting scope/date, backlog and overdue findings, current assignment issues, proposed next
actions and open questions. Keep observed facts separate from proposals. Preserve numbers and
definitions. Use UNKNOWN for causes, approvals or capacity decisions not evidenced.
```

Step 6. Compare every number and HR-case ID in the Word brief to Checks and the evidence register. Add the OneDrive source link and all-filters scope. Log the Word prompt manually in Excel Prompt_Log because Excel cannot access the Word conversation. Save the cleaned workbook and brief for Lab 2.

PROMPT — copy and adapt

```
WORD COPILOT:
Audit this Lumina Living HR service brief against the verified evidence table I supply. Return
a discrepancy list for counts, cost, reporting scope, overdue definition and assignment
claims. Identify missing source links as UNKNOWN. Do not change facts or approve work.
```

Verification

- **Clean table:** 120 unique Case_ID rows; five canonical request types.
- **Portfolio identity:** 120 = 48 Closed + 12 Cancelled + 60 backlog.
- **Evidence handoff:** Overdue 50; unassigned backlog 6; total cost S$35,827.50. Word agrees with Excel.
- **No guessed owner:** Blank assignments remain blank; proposals labelled unapproved.

Expected Outcome

Lumina_Clean_HR_Cases.xlsx and Lumina_HR_Service_Brief.docx, with reconciled counts, reporting scope and a source register.

Checkpoint

If you fell behind, use data/checkpoints/Lumina_Verified_Checkpoint.xlsx and data/checkpoints/Lumina_Verified_Snapshot.docx. Record checkpoint used in Prompt_Log; then perform this lab, rather than claiming the checkpoint as your output.

Troubleshooting

If this happens	Fix
Copilot cannot find the source	Use the app file picker to select the actual OneDrive file. A typed local path or a different app chat is not shared context. If needed copy only the verified snapshot into the current app.
A total disagrees with Control	Clear dashboard filters to All, check table extent and duplicate IDs, recalculate, then compare definitions and reporting date. Reconcile before continuing.
The named feature is missing	Confirm the correct assigned account, English display language and app version. Use the stated manual practice route; record feature unavailable. This is not evidence that a native skill ran.

Challenge

Repeat the task for one different department and explain how the filter scope changes the result. Keep the original verified output.

Reflection

Which evidence proves the output is correct, and which decision still needs a person?

Data note

Lumina Living Pte Ltd and all of its employees, HR cases and HR policies are fictional. Use the verified 120-case baseline and fixed reporting date 30 September 2026. Current case owners are evidence; proposals are not approved. The HR agent answers from approved knowledge only and never approves requests, sends messages or reveals another employee’s data.